



Sarah Friar
Chief Financial Officer

2015
Founded

\$40B+
Run rate (Aug 2026)

\$852B
Valuation (Mar 2026)

~92%
Fortune 500 using ChatGPT

\$20.9B
2025 operating loss

01 Who You're Meeting

Sarah Friar — Chief Financial Officer, OpenAI.

In role: OpenAI's first CFO, joining in June 2024 and starting that August

Today: Leads the finance organisation through an extraordinary capital cycle — a \$122B round at \$852B, roughly \$27B of projected 2026 burn, and preparation for a listing she has told staff will happen in 2027.

Possibly the most relevant commercial counterpart at OpenAI for a private-markets investor, because her entire career has been about taking companies public and running them at scale. She started at McKinsey, working in London and South Africa, then spent roughly a decade at Goldman Sachs, latterly as a managing director and business unit leader for technology. She was SVP of Finance and Strategy at Salesforce, then CFO of Square (now Block) from 2012 to 2018, where she led the 2015 IPO and the company added \$30 billion of market capitalisation.

Career: Chief Financial Officer, OpenAI; Chief Executive Officer, Nextdoor; Chief Financial Officer, Block, Inc. (formerly Square); SVP, Finance & Strategy, Salesforce

Education: MEng Metallurgy, Economics and Management, St Anne's College, University of Oxford; MBA, Stanford Graduate School of Business (Arjay Miller Scholar)

The company: The most broadly adopted AI product in the enterprise — roughly 92% of the Fortune 500 use ChatGPT and business customers passed one million in November 2025 — while carrying losses large enough that the IPO timetable has slipped from a 2026 listing toward 2027.

What they sell: ChatGPT across free, Plus (\$20/month) and Pro (\$200/month) tiers, enterprise plans, and the API and developer platform. An advertising pilot was added during 2026.

02 Where The Company Sits

For a portfolio programme, OpenAI's advantage is penetration: the product is already inside most organisations, often through individual and team subscriptions before IT gets involved, which makes governance rather than procurement the first problem to solve. The strategic risk to watch is what a listing does to the product. A public company optimises for margin and for revenue-driving enterprise features; reporting suggests API-only customers may find themselves in a lower priority tier than large enterprise accounts.

03 Talking Points

- Goldman, McKinsey, two IPOs — she speaks capital-markets language natively and will expect rigour in return.
- As CFO of a pre-IPO company she owns pricing discipline and contract structure. She is the substantive counterpart, not the sales organisation.
- Ask how enterprise commitments are treated in the S-1 narrative; a multi-year PortCo commitment has value to her beyond its revenue.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Leaked audited 2025 figures show \$13.1B of booked revenue against a \$20.9B operating loss — the run-rate numbers and the audited numbers are very different things
- Projected cash burn of roughly \$27B in 2026 and ~\$63B in 2027
- One analyst framing of the valuation is that it prices a monopoly outcome that does not yet exist

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. ChatGPT is near-certain to be present across PortCos already, frequently through unmanaged individual subscriptions — which makes this a governance and consolidation question rather than a vendor selection one.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship. OpenAI is private; the March 2026 round was led by SoftBank and Microsoft.

Others at OpenAI: Sam Altman (Chief Executive Officer)

openai.com · [Stanford Digital Economy Lab profile](#) · [Appointment coverage](#) · [Blavatnik School profile](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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